

AML Alert Triage Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy defines how alerts generated by the Sentinel Transaction Monitoring (Sentinel TM) system are triaged, escalated and dispositioned at Northwind Community Bank (NWB). It sets the scenario thresholds that route alerts to each review tier and the timelines each tier must meet.

2. Review Tiers

Tier	Performed by	Responsibility	Timeline
L1	FCC Operations analyst	Initial review; close as non-suspicious or escalate to L2	Disposition within 2 business days of alert creation
L2	Senior investigator (FIU)	Full investigation; decide case vs. no case; SAR recommendation	Investigation complete within 10 calendar days of escalation
L3	BSA/AML Officer	SAR approval, regulator and law-enforcement liaison	Per NWB-SOP-205 SAR Filing SOP

3. Scenario Thresholds and Routing

Customer risk bands referenced below are defined in NWB-POL-310 Customer Risk Rating Methodology. A customer with a Customer Risk Rating (CRR) score of 70 or above is High risk.

Scenario	Description	Threshold	Routes to
SCN-01	Cash structuring - Low/Medium risk customers	Aggregate cash deposits of \$8,500 or more across a rolling 3 business days, where each deposit is under \$10,000	L2 (escalate directly)
SCN-01H	Cash structuring - High risk customers (CRR 70+)	Aggregate cash deposits of \$6,000 or more across a rolling 7 calendar days, with 3 or more deposits each under \$3,000	L2 immediately; L1 is skipped
SCN-02	Rapid movement of funds	80% or more of incoming funds moved out within 5 days, and total incoming \$25,000 or more	L1
SCN-03	Wire to/from high-risk jurisdiction	Any single wire of \$5,000 or more; \$50,000 or more routes to L2	L1 / L2
SCN-04	Dormant account reactivation	More than \$15,000 of activity within 30 days after 12+ months of dormancy	L1

4. Escalation Rules

- An L1 analyst must escalate to L2 whenever activity cannot be explained by the customer's known profile.
- Alerts for customers already subject to a SAR in the prior 12 months are auto-escalated to L2.
- The date an alert is escalated to L2 is the **initial detection date** for SAR timelines (see NWB-SOP-205).

5. Quality Assurance

FIU QA samples 10% of L1 closures monthly. An error rate above 5% triggers retraining for the analyst.

6. Missed or Delayed Alerts (Data Issues)

If Sentinel TM did not score a business day's transactions, or scored incomplete data, because of an upstream data or pipeline issue, the FCC Operations Manager must request a **lookback run** covering every affected business date. The lookback must be completed within **3 business days** of the data being restored. Alerts generated by a lookback follow normal tier timelines starting on the day the lookback alert is created. If alerts were missed for more than 1 business day, the BSA/AML Officer must be notified in writing.